

Comparative Weighing

What is comparative weighing?

Comparative- Clarifying the binary in the debate

Comparative analysis refers to the process of explaining why one argument, principle, or impact is more important than the opponent's. Winning a debate isn't just about making strong arguments—it's about proving that your arguments matter more than the opposing ones. Comparative analysis is not just rebutting—it's about proving why your side's logic, principles, and consequences should matter more than the opponent's.

TECHNICALLY

There are three types of Comparative Analysis

1. **Impact Comparison** – *Which impact is bigger/more significant?*
 - “Even if their side prevents crime, our side protects millions from oppressive governments.”
 - “Their argument about economic growth is speculative, but our argument about immediate lives lost is certain
2. **Principal Comparison** – *Which principle is more important?*
 - “Their argument on free speech is important, but when free speech leads to real-world harm (e.g., hate speech causing violence), it should be limited.”
 - “They defend parental rights, but we defend children's rights—children are more vulnerable and need greater protection.”
3. **Trade off** – *If we accept one argument, what do we lose?*
 - “If we protect privacy over national security, we risk terrorism. But if we prioritize security, only minor inconveniences occur—so our side is preferable.”
 - “If we prioritize job creation at all costs, we sacrifice long-term environmental survival, which affects everyone

How to prove your argument is important

- **Magnitude** (Which issue affects more people?)
- **Certainty** (Which impact is more likely to happen?)
- **Timeframe** (Which impact will last longer?)
- **Vulnerability** (Which group is most affected?)

Drill

Motion- We should ban video games

Before we get into arguments, let's REVISE

1. What's the fiat in this motion?
2. What is the inherent burden?
3. What's the motion binary?

I HAVE A SAMPLE ARGUMENT FOR YOU ALL TO WORK ON - REMEMBER- TO USE

TITLE

MECH

IMPACT

EXAMPLE

Write 2 arguments on the following sides

Banning violent video games reduces real-world aggression.

Banning violent video games restricts freedom of expression.

You have 10 Minutes to write arguments of both sides on-

This House Would Ban Homework

Use- TIME FRAMEWORK

Title- short and simple

Mech- why? Why? Why?

Impact- what are you getting in the end ?

Example- :))))))

NOW YOU JUDGE YOUR OWN ARGUMENTs

Tell me which side wins and why

Why is the most important part :))))))

To do before you run out

PLEASE RATE THE SESSION :oo

1. On a scale of 1 to 10
2. What did you learn?
3. What could have been better ?
4. Be old school and write this down with pen paper and be super analytic
(bring mech alive in real life - Tell me the whyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyy :)))))))))